

YASH SONI

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EDUCATION

Wilfrid Laurier University

B.Sc in Data Science | Big Data Concentration | Economics Minor

Expected Graduation: April 2027

Waterloo, ON

EXPERIENCE

Data Scientist Intern

Manulife Financial

May 2026 - August 2026

Toronto, ON

- Supporting Manulife's **Generative AI team** in building governed analytics and **LLM solutions** for Risk, Treasury, and Finance stakeholders.

Data Engineer Intern

Manulife Financial

September 2025 - December 2025

Toronto, ON

- Used **PySpark and SQL in Databricks** to process financial data for Global Wealth and Asset Management, supporting a **9% return** performance.
- Automated ingestion and transformation workflows in Databricks, **reducing processing time by 30%** for ML and LLM use cases internally.
- Built PySpark monitoring pipelines to track operations and data quality, **improving execution reliability by 25%** across core reporting workflows.
- Migrated legacy SQL workflows to PySpark to support scalable lakehouse analytics, enterprise data processing, and financial reporting.
- Partnered with engineers, analysts, and stakeholders to deliver clean, version-controlled datasets for modeling and reporting initiatives.

Teaching Assistant

Wilfrid Laurier University

September 2024 - April 2025

Waterloo, ON

- Supported **200+ students** in Data Analytics and Calculus by clearly explaining concepts and debugging **Python and R** code.
- Guided students in labs through functions, statistical models, and regression interpretation in real time during lab sessions and assignments.
- Graded 200+ assignments with consistent feedback across code, math, and written analysis under tight academic marking timelines.

Data Analyst Intern

RBC

May 2024 - August 2024

Toronto, ON

- Validated daily mortgage disbursement data **exceeding \$2.5M with 97% accuracy** to maintain compliance and reporting accuracy daily.
- Built **Power BI dashboards and Excel trackers** that reduced escalation time for corrupted records by **20%** across operational workflows.
- Worked with reconciliation, risk, and compliance teams to resolve discrepancies and strengthen internal reporting controls.

Software Engineer Intern

Riipen Networks

January 2024 - April 2024

Toronto, ON

- Worked with developers, UX, and marketing teams to improve partner-facing web apps, increasing session time by **15%** overall.
- Created SEO-focused blog and landing page content using keyword and user journey analysis for improved discoverability.
- Turned behavioral analytics into front-end improvements aligned with sprint goals and broader rollout plans.

PROJECTS

Cortex, HackCanada 2026 | Next.js, React, TypeScript, Three.js, FastAPI, Python, Google Gemini

[Live Demo](#)

- Built Cortex, an AI platform that ingests **GitHub repositories, PDFs, and text** to evaluate skills across **51 computer science categories**.
- Created an interactive **Three.js 3D brain** that visualizes skill strength across 9 regions and updates as users upload new evidence.
- Built a **FastAPI** scoring pipeline with Google Gemini to analyze content, generate skill scores, and power chatbot feedback.
- Added weighted profile merging and keyword fallback logic to improve scoring consistency and reliability across upload types.

Credit Card Fraud Detection | Python, PyTorch, NumPy, Pandas, pytest

- Built a preprocessing pipeline for anonymized transaction data, including cleaning, scaling, and validation for imbalanced classification.
- Implemented a **PyTorch MLP** for fraud detection using weighted binary cross-entropy to address class imbalance.
- Designed a risk scoring workflow to evaluate model performance across thresholds and review queue scenarios.
- Achieved **0.73 PR-AUC** and **80% recall** at an operational decision threshold using PR-AUC and ROC-AUC evaluation.

GenAI Finance Assistant | Python, Flask, LangChain, OpenAI API

- Built a retrieval-augmented assistant that explains portfolio metrics, financial statements, and market indicators.
- Engineered a vector retrieval pipeline to fetch relevant context before LLM response generation.
- Developed a **Flask REST API** for conversational querying over financial datasets.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, R, C/C++, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, VBA

Platforms & Tools: Azure Databricks, Snowflake, Jupyter, Git, Linux, Power BI, Excel, Streamlit

Libraries & Frameworks: Pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, PyTorch, Matplotlib, pytest, LangChain, React

Relevant Courses: Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Data Mining, Algorithm Design/Analysis